Guitar Exercises - Section XIV, Level 99

Repertoire-Set Construction and Live-Set Performance

Sequencing • Between-Song Transitions • Endurance • Memory Recovery • Gear Discipline • Stage Reliability

Level 99 of the fixed 105-level core curriculum. This completes Section XIV. HARD STOP after Level 105.

Level 99 changes the unit of practice again. The problem is no longer one song. It is maintaining musical quality, memory, tone, timing, and decision-making across several complete pieces without a reset.

Module	Exercise	Events
A	Set-selection and sequencing logic	112
B	Between-song transition design	128
C	Endurance and concentration management	128
D	Memory retrieval and cold-start drills	128
E	Gear/patch/volume discipline	112
F	Stage-cue and count-in reliability	112
G	Failure recovery across a multi-piece set	128
H	Three complete repertoire-set rehearsals	240
I	Thirty-minute live-set capstone	360
J	Section XIV completion audit	64
	TOTAL	1512

Core rule: the set is one performance, not a collection of isolated songs.

Reference - Set Construction Priorities

Priority	Question
1. Reliability	Can every piece currently survive a no-restart take?
2. Contrast	Do adjacent pieces differ in groove, key, register, or dynamic shape?
3. Energy arc	Where does intensity rise, peak, reset, and close?
4. Technical load	Are the hardest pieces clustered together?
5. Setup load	Do patch/tuning/capo changes create unnecessary risk?
6. Memory load	Are similar intros/keys placed where confusion is likely?
7. Ending	Does the final piece feel conclusive?

The strongest individual song is not automatically the strongest opener or closer.

Module A - Set-Selection Matrix

Piece	Groove	Key	Energy	Technical load	Role
A	straight rock	E	4/5	3/5	opener candidate
B	soul/R&B	C	2/5	2/5	contrast
C	shuffle	A	3/5	3/5	mid-set lift
D	minor ballad	Am	1/5	2/5	reset
E	funk	D	4/5	4/5	peak candidate
F	jam-band	G	3/5	3/5	open development
G	country/Americana	G	2/5	3/5	texture contrast
H	finale piece	C	5/5	4/5	closer candidate

Build three different six-piece set orders. Explain the purpose of each sequence in one sentence.

Module A - Sequencing Constraints

Constraint	Exercise
No same key twice in a row	reorder set without damaging energy arc
No two highest-load pieces adjacent	protect endurance
One low-energy reset before final peak	create headroom
At least three groove families	maintain contrast
One solo/acoustic texture	create sonic reset
Final piece must end decisively	avoid weak close
Maximum two gear changes	reduce stage risk

A set order should solve musical and logistical problems simultaneously.

Module B - Between-Song Transition Types

Type	Method	Risk
Hard stop	complete ending, count-in next piece	dead time / weak reset
Sustained bridge	hold common tone/chord into next intro	intonation / tuning
Rhythmic handoff	outro groove becomes next count	tempo drift
Common-tone link	one shared pitch changes harmonic meaning	unclear key center
Noise/texture bridge	controlled swell/harmonic/mute texture	overlong transition
Spoken count only	clean cutoff, immediate count	memory cold-start
Medley	next piece begins before applause/rest	form confusion

Design at least three transition types across one six-piece set. Not every song needs a clever bridge.

Module B - Transition Drill Cards

Card	End of Piece 1	Start of Piece 2	Task
1	E5 sustain	G major intro	use B common tone
2	Cmaj7 whole note	Am pickup	let E remain through change
3	A7 shuffle	D funk vamp	convert triplet feel to straight grid after cutoff
4	G acoustic ending	E rock intro	full stop + exact count-in
5	Dm7-G7-C ending	C pedal intro	hold C, change texture
6	feedback/swell ending	quiet ballad	reduce level before first count

The transition passes only if Piece 2 begins at the intended tempo and dynamic.

Module C - Endurance without Technique Collapse

Block	Duration	Goal
1	5 min	two easy pieces, no breaks
2	10 min	three pieces, one transition
3	15 min	four pieces, no restart
4	20 min	five pieces, dynamic arc intact
5	25 min	add one high-load piece late
6	30 min	full capstone set

Increase duration before increasing tempo or technical density. The final song must sound intentional, not merely survived.

Module C - Fatigue Diagnostics

Symptom	Likely cause	Repair
fretting pressure rises	hand fatigue / tension	simplify voicing, loosen grip
rushes late in set	attention fatigue	foot pulse / reduce fills
bends go sharp	grip fatigue	use plain target or calibrated smaller bend
fills overrun	decision fatigue	remove fills for one piece
tone gets noisy	muting fatigue	reduce gain/density
memory blanks	cognitive load	landmark map + roots

Fatigue management is part of performance design, not an excuse after a mistake.

Module D - Cold-Start Memory Retrieval

Prompt	Time limit
Name first chord + count-in for any piece	5 sec
Play first 2 bars from silence	5 sec
Name last chord before chorus	5 sec
Start from bridge without intro	10 sec
Play outro from memory	10 sec
State emergency version of current section	5 sec
Transpose first chord sequence to new key verbally	10 sec

Randomize the order. A set requires retrieval from many starting points, not only from the beginning.

Module D - Mid-Song Memory Recovery

Failure	Recovery anchor
forgot exact fill	skip it; hit next chord
forgot next lyric/vocal cue	use bar count / drummer cue
forgot voicing	root + third shell
forgot solo lick	target note + space
forgot section order	jump to next unmistakable landmark
confused two similar intros	stop after count-in and identify tonic/rhythm before attack
missed repeat	follow ensemble if authoritative

A memory error should reduce detail, not stop the set.

Module E - Gear/Patch Discipline

Variable	Pre-set rule
Instrument tuning	check before set and designated reset point
Volume	unity reference; avoid uncontrolled jumps
Gain	minimum needed for articulation goal
Modulation/delay	one reason per patch
Capo	pre-stage / mark fret / verify tuning
Pickup selection	write only if arrangement depends on it
Patch change	one action where possible
Backup tone	one generic safe patch for all pieces

The workbook trains performance behavior, not brand-specific gear programming.

Module E - Patch Change Drill

Transition	Allowed actions
clean -> crunch	1 switch
crunch -> lead	1 switch + volume check
electric -> acoustic instrument	instrument swap + count-in only
capo change	capo + tuning spot check
lead -> clean ballad	patch + guitar-volume reset
patch failure	generic backup patch immediately

Practice patch changes as part of the ending/intro transition, not separately from the set.

Module F - Count-In and Stage-Cue Reliability

Cue	Requirement
4-count	tempo already internal before '1'
2-bar count	subdivision spoken/clapped internally
visual nod	attack together without verbal cue
drum pickup	do not add guitar pickup unless arranged
bass pickup	leave space and land beat 1
held hand/cutoff	release together
extra bar signal	repeat minimal figure
solo cue	change role, not form

Record ten consecutive count-ins. The first beat should land at the intended tempo without correction.

Module G - Multi-Piece Failure Recovery

Injected failure	Required response
wrong patch at intro	play simplified part until safe change
missed first chord	enter on next landmark
broken transition	hard stop + clean count-in
tempo drifts	simplify rhythm, lock to pulse
memory blank	roots + section landmark
string/noise issue	reduce role while preserving form
solo fails	target notes + rests
ending missed	follow ensemble cutoff; do not add extra chord

After recovery, continue directly into the next song. Do not stop the set to discuss the mistake.

Module G - Recovery Priority across the Set

Priority	Protect
1	pulse/count
2	current section
3	ensemble cue
4	chord function
5	role
6	signature landmark
7	tone/articulation
8	optional detail

The farther down the list the error occurs, the less reason there is to interrupt the performance.

Module H - Set Rehearsal 1 - Reliability

Length: 6 pieces / ~20 min

Choose easiest viable sequence. No experimental transitions. Goal: zero restarts.

Pass	Requirement
1	set list spoken from memory
2	first/last chord cold starts
3	transition-only rehearsal
4	full uninterrupted set
5	post-set note: top 3 failures only
6	repeat only after targeted repair

Module H - Set Rehearsal 2 - Contrast

Length: 6 pieces / ~25 min

Reorder for maximum groove/key/dynamic contrast. Add three designed transitions.

Pass	Requirement
1	set list spoken from memory
2	first/last chord cold starts
3	transition-only rehearsal
4	full uninterrupted set
5	post-set note: top 3 failures only
6	repeat only after targeted repair

Module H - Set Rehearsal 3 - Performance

Length: 7-8 pieces / ~30 min

Use final patch map, memory starts, cue changes, one injected failure, and full energy arc.

Pass	Requirement
1	set list spoken from memory
2	first/last chord cold starts
3	transition-only rehearsal
4	full uninterrupted set
5	post-set note: top 3 failures only
6	repeat only after targeted repair

Module I - Thirty-Minute Live-Set Capstone

#	Role	Groove	Key	Energy	Transition
1	Opener	Rock	E	4	clean stop -> count
2	Contrast	Soul/R&B	C	2	common-tone link
3	Lift	Shuffle	A	3	rhythmic handoff
4	Reset	Minor ballad	Am	1	full stop
5	Peak 1	Funk	D	4	short texture bridge
6	Open section	Jam-band	G	3	medley-style link
7	Texture contrast	Americana	G	2	hard stop
8	Finale	Integrated	C	5	decisive ending

Use original studies, public-domain material, your own repertoire, or pieces you already have legal access to. The workbook evaluates integration, not specific copyrighted songs.

Module I - Capstone Performance Requirements

Requirement	Standard
Total duration	approximately 25-30 minutes
Restarts	0
Unplanned dead time	under 15 seconds total
Set list memory	complete
Cold starts	all 8 pieces
Designed transitions	minimum 3
Dynamic arc	at least one reset and two peaks
Injected failure	recover without stopping set
Gear/patch changes	executed within transition plan
Final ending	clear and intentional

Record the entire set in one file. Do not edit mistakes out before review.

Module J - Section XIV Completion Audit

Category	0	1	2
Set sequencing	random	functional	architected
Transitions	break flow	usable	musical
Endurance	degrades	survives	stable
Memory	frequent loss	recovers	secure
Gear discipline	disruptive	functional	invisible
Cue/count-in reliability	inconsistent	mostly	precise
Recovery	restart	simplifies	seamless
Complete performance	fragmented	complete	convincing

Pass Section XIV: 14/16 or better on two separate full-set days, with no zero in endurance, memory, recovery, or complete performance.

Section XIV is now complete. Level 100 begins Section XV: Composition & Improvisational Composition - motif generation, harmonic constraints, bass-first and melody-first writing, form design, development, arrangement, and complete original pieces.

Fixed roadmap: Levels 100-104 Composition; Level 105 Final Musicianship Capstone. HARD STOP after Level 105.